



AWS Organizations – Hands-On Lab



Objective:

Learn how to create and manage AWS Organizations, add accounts, group them using Organizational Units (OUs), and apply Service Control Policies (SCPs).



Pre-requisites

- AWS root/management account access (use only for lab purposes).
 - Billing enabled with a valid payment method.
 - IAM user with full admin access (recommended instead of using root directly).
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Lab Guide



Step 1: Create an Organization

1. Sign in to the **AWS Management Console** using your **root account** or admin IAM user.
2. Go to **AWS Organizations** → Click on "**Create Organization**".
3. Choose:
 -  **Enable All Features**
4. You now have:
 - **Management Account**

- **Organization Root**
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✓ **Step 2: Add Member Accounts**

Option A: Create a New AWS Account

1. Click on **Accounts** → **Add an AWS account**.
2. Choose **Create an AWS account**.
3. Provide:
 - Account name: **DevAccount**
 - Email address: Use a different email (e.g., dev@example.com)
 - IAM role name: Default (**OrganizationAccountAccessRole**)

Option B: Invite an Existing Account

1. Choose **Invite an AWS account**.
 2. Enter the email/account ID of an existing account.
 3. Accept the invitation from the invited account via email/console.
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✓ **Step 3: Create Organizational Units (OUs)**

1. Navigate to the **Organize accounts** tab.
2. Click **Add organizational unit**.
3. Name it:
 - **DevOU** for development accounts.

4. Drag and drop **DevAccount** under **DevOU**.

✓ Step 4: Create and Attach a Service Control Policy (SCP)

SCPs set **permission boundaries** for member accounts.

1. Go to **Policies** → **Service Control Policies** → **Create policy**.
2. Name: **DenyS3Delete**

Paste the following policy:

```
{
  "Version": "2012-10-17",
  "Statement": [
    {
      "Sid": "DenyS3Delete",
      "Effect": "Deny",
      "Action": "s3:DeleteBucket",
      "Resource": "*"
    }
  ]
}
```

- 3.
4. Click **Create policy**.
5. Go to **DevOU** → **Attach policies** → Select **DenyS3Delete**.

✓ Step 5: Test the Policy (from Member Account)

1. Sign in to the **DevAccount** (newly created or invited).
2. Use the IAM role **OrganizationAccountAccessRole** from the management account, or login with a user in the member account.

Try to run:

```
aws s3api delete-bucket --bucket test-bucket
```

- 3.
4.  You should receive a “**Access Denied**” message.

Step 6: Enable Consolidated Billing (Optional)

1. Go to **Billing Dashboard** → **Consolidated Billing**.
2. Confirm that all linked accounts show under one bill.
3. Explore **Cost Explorer** to break down usage by linked accounts.

Step 7: Clean Up (If this is a temporary lab)

- Detach and delete any test SCPs.
- Remove OUs if not needed.
- Remove test member accounts (only if created for lab).
- Disable the organization from the management account settings ( irreversible and not recommended if you plan to continue using it).

Learning Outcomes

By completing this lab, you will understand how to:

- Create an AWS Organization
- Add and manage accounts
- Create and manage Organizational Units

- Apply SCPs to restrict permissions
 - Test policies using IAM users in member accounts
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Next Steps

- 💡 Try more SCP examples (e.g., deny EC2 termination, restrict regions).
 - 🏗️ Explore **AWS Control Tower** for automated account provisioning.
 - 🔑 Integrate **AWS IAM Identity Center (SSO)** for user access.
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